



# FAITH INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

## AT 5540 – Christian Ethics: Principles & Praxis Online Course Syllabus

|                  |                                             |                |                                                          |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Title</b>     | Christian Ethics: Principles & Praxis       | <b>Number</b>  | AT 5540                                                  |
| <b>Hours</b>     | 4                                           | <b>Type</b>    | On-Line                                                  |
| <b>Professor</b> | Bruce L Bronoske Sr, DMin                   | <b>Contact</b> | bbronoske@faithseminary.edu<br>(Use Mail icon in Canvas) |
| <b>Campus</b>    | 3504 North Pearl Street<br>Tacoma, WA 98407 | <b>Office</b>  | (253) 752-2020                                           |

***It is essential that each student read this course syllabus thoroughly and completely before beginning any of the assigned coursework. Questions about course requirements should be directed to the professor of record.***

### Course Description

This course examines foundations of three basic areas of ethics: 1) biblical principles that guide ethical decisions, 2) standards of the world that conflict with biblical views, and 3) critical contemporary ethical issues that demand attention and serious study.

#### Rationale:

Ethics has been described as the principles or rules of conduct – a system of moral values and duties that govern one's life. Ethics has to do with ideal human character, actions and ends. What ought a person do or refrain from doing? What attitudes or behavior should be viewed as good and why? These are some of the questions this study seeks to help answer.

### Canvas Interaction Requirements

Student interaction is an integral part of the Online/Distance Education learning experience. Successful completion of this course requires that students log into the course via the Canvas Learning Management System. Regular and substantive interaction with both the instructor and classmates is required throughout the quarter. Academic exercises will be listed on the course syllabus and include, but are not limited to, reading textbooks and journal articles, watching videos, listening to audio, PowerPoint/PDF slides, discussion postings, quizzes, examinations, reflection and/or research papers, written assignments, field work, and practicums. Regular and timely participation in is expected in all courses at Faith.

#### Faculty Interaction Requirements:

The professor will provide students with specific details relevant to assigned coursework. He/she will submit student feedback via Canvas within a reasonable timeframe. Each professor is committed to engaging with students in a manner that is courteous, professional and consistent with Christian character (Galatians 5:22–23, 6:1–2; John 13:34–35, and so on).

#### Substantive Interaction Statement:

A student may be withdrawn for cause by either the instructor or the Registrar. A student who does not participate regularly and substantively, and/or whose number of absences prevents him/her from meeting the objectives of the course, will be withdrawn for failure to maintain Satisfactory Academic Progress (as defined in the Academic Catalog). Students who do not check-in to a course and interact substantively within the first two weeks of a quarter are subject to Administrative Withdrawal (WX) as defined in the Academic Catalog.

## Course Texts

### Required:

Holmes, Arthur F. *Ethics: Approaching Moral Decisions*. 2d ed. Downers Grove, IL: InterVarsity Press Academic, 2007.

(150 pages) ..... (estimated cost new: \$12.55) **ISBN: 978-0830828036**

Milco, Michael R. *Ethical Dilemmas in Church Leadership: Case Studies in Biblical Decision-Making*. Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel Publications, 1997.

(192 pages) ..... (estimated cost new: \$14.32) **ISBN: 978-0825431975**

Rae, Scott B. *Moral Choices, An Introduction to Ethics*. 3d ed. Grand Rapids, MI: Zondervan, 2009.

(384 pages) ..... (estimated cost new: \$21.67) **ISBN: 978-0310291091**

## Course Goals / Student Learning Objectives

*Upon successful completion of this course, the student should be able to understand:*

1. the biblical definition of 'love' and the importance of biblical love for the believer as a foundation of ethical behavior,
2. how the Old Testament law interacts with New Testament faith, hope and love,
3. and recognize the pitfalls of situational ethics,
4. the Biblical view of various key life issues,
5. the role of the church in society as it relates to government, schools and the media, and
6. ethical questions in which Christians differ and matters that are not directly revealed in Scripture.

## Assessment Tools Matrix

| Assessment Tools    | Student Learning Objective 1 | Student Learning Objective 2 | Student Learning Objective 3 | Student Learning Objective 4 | Student Learning Objective 5 | Student Learning Objective 6 |
|---------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Discussion Boards   | (x)                          |                              |                              |                              | (x)                          | (x)                          |
| Reading Assignments | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          |
| Written Assignments | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          |
| Exams               | (x)                          | (x)                          |                              | (x)                          | (x)                          | (x)                          |
|                     |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                     |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                     |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |
|                     |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |                              |

## Course Requirements

**Important:** All coursework will be submitted through Canvas in each assignment's drop box. Do not submit your coursework or assignments anywhere else, as there is no guarantee they will be received by the proper instructor at the proper time. "Violators will be persecuted!" 😊

1) **Student Introduction:** ..... (10 points)  
Please introduce yourself to your classmates. Let them know a little bit about you.

2) **Reflection Papers:** (2 @ 20 points each) ..... (40 points)  
Each reflection paper is to be double-spaced, font size 12, one-inch (1") margin all around and a **full three (3) pages** in length (but, 3 pages maximum), submitted with a coversheet.

From each of the two texts (Milco & Holmes) choose 3 or 4 concepts presented within the text that you felt were particularly important and write briefly about each. Explain why you thought each was a key concept in Christian ministry. Relate each concept to your own life and personal ministry situation or setting.

3) **On-Line Discussions:** (2 @ 15 points each) ..... (30 points)  
Student will participate in two (2) on-line discussions on topics of the instructor's choosing.

4) **Course Exams:** (3 @ 40 points each) ..... (120 points)  
Students will engage a total of three (3) exams. Each exam is 'open book' and covers a specific section of the text by Rae. Take good, copious notes when you read your text.

Students are encouraged to keep the following in mind as they prepare for the exams:

**Exams are automatically timed.** Once the exam is opened in Canvas, the clock begins. Each student will have the same specified time within which to complete the full exam. At the end of the allotted time, the exam will automatically close.

**Exams cannot be stopped.** Make sure you have the full uninterrupted time set aside to begin and complete the exam or time will expire before you have finished. (It happens!)

**Exams cannot be re-entered.** Be fully prepared! Have the text and your notes ready.

**Provide the 'meat' of the answer!** Answer each question briefly and completely. Be specific! There will be little time for added 'fluff,' and it will not boost your grade!

## Grading Scale and Weights

| Score    | Grade | Points |           | Assignment                  | Points     |
|----------|-------|--------|-----------|-----------------------------|------------|
| 98 – 100 | A+    | 4.0    | Superior  | Student Introduction        | 10         |
| 94 – 97  | A     | 4.0    | Excellent | Discussion 1                | 15         |
| 90 – 93  | A–    | 3.7    |           | Discussion 2                | 15         |
| 87 – 89  | B+    | 3.3    |           | Reflection Paper 1 (Holmes) | 20         |
| 84 – 86  | B     | 3.0    | Good      | Reflection Paper 2 (Milco)  | 20         |
| 80 – 83  | B–    | 2.7    |           | Exam 1 (Rae, Chap 1-4)      | 40         |
| 77 – 79  | C+    | 2.3    |           | Exam 2 (Rae, Chap 5-8)      | 40         |
| 74 – 76  | C     | 2.0    | Average   | Exam 3 (Rae, Chap 9-12)     | 40         |
| 70 – 73  | C–    | 1.7    |           | <b>Point Total:</b>         | <b>200</b> |
| 67 – 69  | D+    | 1.3    |           |                             |            |
| 64 – 66  | D     | 1.0    | Below Avg |                             |            |
| 60 – 63  | D–    | 0.7    |           |                             |            |
| Below 60 | F     | 0.0    | Failing   |                             |            |

## Grading Policies

1. **Course Term:** Each student has the **ten (10) week term** time period within which to complete all course requirements. It is the student's responsibility to contact the instructor if the student is unable to complete the course requirements within the ten-week period.
2. **Submission of Coursework:** All coursework requirements are to be submitted through the Canvas Learning Management System, which is the only approved method of submission!
3. **Course Requirements:** All course requirements are to be completed and submitted in accordance with the instructions and guidelines of this syllabus and contained under the "Modules" tab in the Canvas Learning Management System. All course materials must be finalized and submitted no later than the last day of the quarter or the student must request a course extension. Late submissions will affect the student's final grade.
4. **Coursework Extensions:** If a course extension is needed, the student must request (on-line) and be granted, an extension through the Office of the Registrar no later than the last day of the quarter. A fee will be exacted for all course extensions. If an extension is not requested, a grade of "F" will be recorded for that work.
5. **Writing Standards:** Writing standards for course assignments will be in accordance with The Chicago Style Documentation System as defined in the publication "Form & Style" thirteenth edition by Carole Slade & Robert Perrin, **ISBN: 978-0618559473**.

## End of Course Evaluations

Completing the end of course Evaluation is a *required* element in each course. Students need to complete the evaluation in Populi prior to their grades being visible at the end of each quarter. Once the End of Course Evaluation has been completed and your professor has finalized the course your grade will be visible within Populi. The evaluation is available week 8

## Faith Policy / Academic Integrity

### Biblical Code of Conduct:

Faith International University is a community of Christian believers who confess and follow Jesus Christ as Lord and Savior. The community is expected to uphold the Word of God and apply biblical standards of morality and integrity in life.

Students are expected, therefore, to conduct themselves in a manner in keeping with Christian decorum and testimony. This involves embracing attitudes and actions the Bible identifies as virtuous and avoiding attitudes and actions the Bible identifies as sinful. Students are required to abide by all published policies, codes, and regulations prescribed by the institution. Students also must abide by applicable local, state, and federal laws. The institution reserves the right to require disciplinary action of students whose behavior is in conflict with the Biblical Code of Conduct

### Academic Code of Honor:

Christian character and academic honesty are foundational to the mission of Faith International University. Students are expected to demonstrate integrity and honor utilizing any mode of instruction and recognize the importance of being accountable for personal academic behavior.

Students have the responsibility to be knowledgeable of and abide by the Academic Code of Honor and encourage honesty and integrity among fellow students. Students are required to conduct themselves in a Christ-like manner both behaviorally and ethically during the entire process of their education or be subject to disciplinary action. A non-exhaustive list of behavioral and ethical standards is offered below.

**Behavioral Standards:**

1. Students will attend all class sessions, arrive on time, and remain until dismissed.
2. Students will be respectful, courteous, and civil when communicating verbally or in writing with their instructor, fellow students, other faculty members, or administrative staff.
3. Students will be prepared for class and maintain an appropriate academic climate by refraining from all actions that disrupt the learning environment.
4. Students will do assigned coursework in a consistent, timely manner throughout the quarter.
5. Students will pay tuition, fees, and other charges according to financial policies.

**Ethical Standards:**

1. Students will submit their own course work.
2. Students will not cheat by utilizing unauthorized communication of information or give illicit aid to other students on examinations, papers, or projects.
3. Students will not plagiarize by representing someone else's words or ideas from books, articles, electronic sources (Internet), Bible software, etc., as one's own without proper citation.
4. Students will not falsify, distort, or invent any information, data, or citation.
5. Students will not submit the same work to more than one class or submit any work that has been used to fulfill the requirements of another course previously taken at another school.

**Mission Statement**

Faith International University exists to glorify God by equipping Christian leaders with a biblical, theological, and practical education empowering them to apply and proclaim the inerrant Word of God for worldwide Christian service.

**Accessibility and Consent Agreement****Disability and Support Services (DSS):**

If you are a student with a disability and want to discuss or request services, please contact the Disability Support Services (DSS) office. Accommodations for qualified students are handled through this office. The Coordinator for DSS can be reached at (253) 752-2020 x120.

**Consent Agreement**

An on-line/distance learning course requires frequent interaction with your instructor. It is, therefore, essential that you agree to the conditions set forth in the course syllabus. After you have read the course syllabus, let us know (do not wait) if you do not agree with the course conditions and requirements. If we do not hear from you within three (3) days from the start of the course, we will assume you agree with the conditions set forth in the syllabus.

## Academic Work Quality

Faith International University strives to bring its students quality instruction in order to challenge students to their highest levels of performance. Students are exposed to high-quality textbooks, journals, and other scholarly media as part of required coursework. Likewise, students are expected to focus on high-quality academic sources in their own coursework and research when writing and submitting papers, theses, or presenting similar assignments and projects. A hierarchy of scholarly research books and journals exists from which acceptable research reading and citation sources may be obtained.

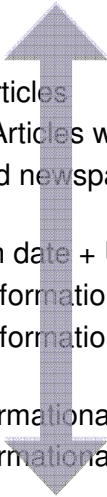
Excellent book and journal resources, as well as reference books are found in the FIU and other libraries. Additionally, many important and classic works may be found online and in Bible and research software packages. The Internet is mixed in the quality of research resources to be found, however good sources are available if students look carefully.

Impeccable citation of sources is expected and students should limit direct quotations to a maximum of thirty percent of the paper or presentation.

The following is a general “Hierarchy of Sources” for research and study:

### Hierarchy of Sources

*Most Acceptable/Academic Internet Sources*

- 
- Primary source documents
  - Established classic volumes
  - Peer-reviewed books and journal articles
  - Journal Articles with DOI / Journal Articles with URL
  - Dual print and electronic established newspaper/news magazine + publication date + URL
  - Electronic news media + publication date + URL
  - Established/formal organization's informational media + publication date + URL
  - Established/formal organization's informational media + no pub. date + access date + URL
  - Popular/informal organization's informational media + publication date + URL
  - Popular/informal organization's informational media + no publication date + access date + URL

*Least Acceptable Sources*

| Schedule             | Course Module Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Due Date                         |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Module 1<br>Week 1   | Read Rae – Introduction & Chapter 1<br>Read Milco – Introduction<br>Read Holmes – Introduction & Chapter 1<br><b>Student Introduction</b>                                                                                             | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 1</b>  |
| Module 2<br>Week 2   | Read Rae – Chapter 2<br>Read Milco – Chapter 1<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 2 & 3                                                                                                                                                         | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 2</b>  |
| Module 3<br>Week 3   | Read Rae – Chapter 3<br>Read Milco – Chapter 2<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 4<br><b>Engage Discussion Question 1</b>                                                                                                                      | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 3</b>  |
| Module 4<br>Week 4   | Read Rae – Chapter 4<br>Read Milco – Chapter 3<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 5<br><b>Take EXAM 1 (covering Rae chapters 1 thru 4)</b>                                                                                                      | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 4</b>  |
| Module 5<br>Week 5   | Read Rae – Chapter 5 & 6<br>Read Milco – Chapter 6<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 6 & 7                                                                                                                                                     | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 5</b>  |
| Module 6<br>Week 6   | Read Rae – Chapter 7<br>Read Milco – Chapter 8<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 8                                                                                                                                                             | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 6</b>  |
| Module 7<br>Week 7   | Read Rae – Chapter 8<br>Read Milco – Chapter 7<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 9<br><b>Take EXAM 2 (covering Rae chapters 5 thru 8)</b>                                                                                                      | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 7</b>  |
| Module 8<br>Week 8   | Read Rae – Chapter 9 & 10<br>Read Milco – Chapter 9<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 10 & 11<br><b>Engage Discussion Question 2</b>                                                                                                           | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 8</b>  |
| Module 9<br>Week 9   | Read Rae – Chapter 11<br>Read Milco – Chapter 4<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 12                                                                                                                                                           | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 9</b>  |
| Module 10<br>Week 10 | Read Rae – Chapter 12<br>Read Milco – Chapter 5<br>Read Holmes – Chapter 13 & 14<br><b>Reflection Paper 1 DUE (Milco Text)</b><br><b>Reflection Paper 2 DUE (Holmes Text)</b><br><b>Take EXAM 3 (covering Rae chapters 9 thru 12)</b> | <b>FRIDAY<br/>OF<br/>WEEK 10</b> |

**STUDENT NOTE:** The weekly reading assignments (listed above) have been established with the intent that the student would be reading approximately 12-15 pages of required textual material each day. It is critical that each student put forth every effort to remain current with this schedule during the course of the study in order to finish all course requirements in a timely manner.